Secure print release with your badge

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Summary

This article explains how to use your Acme ID badge to securely release print jobs from any PaperCut-enabled printer. It covers the self-service steps for users, common symptoms and causes, and the service-desk troubleshooting process.

Symptoms

- Printer displays "Offline" or "Not ready" in the print queue
- Print jobs remain stuck in the queue with status "Printing" or "Error - Printing"
- Attempt to add the office printer fails with error "0x000006d1" or "Cannot connect to printer"
- Released pages come out blank or with only faint marks
- Badge tap does not trigger the release screen on the printer panel

Common causes

- Corrupted or stalled print spooler service on the workstation
- Out-of-date or incorrect printer driver installed
- Low toner or empty cartridge reported by the printer hardware
- Network connectivity issue between the workstation and print.acme.example
- Badge reader malfunction or missing proximity-card driver on the printer

How Secure Print Release Works

Acme uses PaperCut secure print release to protect confidential documents. When you send a print job, it is held in a queue on the print server until you authenticate at the printer with your Acme ID badge. The badge tap triggers a credential check against Microsoft Entra ID, and the server releases the job to the selected device. This ensures that prints are only released when you are physically present.

Self-Help: Release a Print Job Using Your Badge

Follow these steps to release a held print job from any PaperCut-enabled printer using your badge. If the badge does not work, proceed to the troubleshooting section.

1. Ensure your document has been sent to the printer (look for the job in your local print queue or in the PaperCut web portal at https://print.acme.example).
2. Walk to the printer and locate the badge reader (usually near the control panel).
3. Tap your Acme ID badge firmly against the reader; wait for the green light or beep.
4. On the printer touchscreen, select "Release Print Jobs" or similar option.
5. Choose the job(s) you wish to release from the list and press "Print" or "Release".
6. Collect your output from the output tray. If the job does not appear, repeat steps 2-4 or try a different printer.

Troubleshooting Common Secure Print Issues

If tapping your badge does not bring up the release screen, or jobs stay stuck in the queue, try the following checks before contacting the service desk.

1. Verify that the printer shows an "Online" status on the control panel; if it reads "Offline", check the network cable or Wi-Fi connection.
2. Restart your computer's print spooler: open Services (services.msc), locate "Print Spooler", right-click and select Restart.
3. Remove and re-add the printer via the PaperCut portal: go to https://print.acme.example, click "Add Printer", follow the wizard, and test a print page.
4. Check toner levels via the printer's status menu; replace or request a refill if low.
5. Try a different badge; if the second badge works, the original may be demagnetized or defective.

Service Desk Procedure: Diagnose and Resolve Secure Print Release Problems

Use this procedure when a user reports that secure print release is not functioning. Follow the steps in order, documenting each action.

1. Ask the user to confirm they have sent a print job and that the printer shows an online status.
2. Remotely check the print server (print.acme.example) for the job status in the PaperCut admin console; note if the job is held, paused, or in error.
3. Verify the user's badge is active in Entra ID: run Get-MgUser -UserId <user> and confirm MFA and device compliance.
4. Restart the Print Spooler service on the user's workstation via PowerShell: Restart-Service -Name Spooler -Force.
5. If the spooler restart does not clear the queue, purge all jobs: Stop-Service Spooler, delete files in C:\Windows\System32\spool\PRINTERS, then Start-Service Spooler.
6. Re-install the printer driver: remove the existing printer, download the latest driver from the manufacturer, and add the printer again via \\print.acme.example\<printer-name>.
7. Test badge authentication by tapping the badge at the printer while observing the reader logs (if available) or asking the user to attempt release.
8. If the badge still fails, escalate to the Identity & Access Management team for badge reader configuration or replacement.
9. Document the resolution and close the ticket with confirmation that the user can successfully release a print job.

Verification and Confirmation

After completing the self-help or service-desk steps, verify that the issue is resolved.

1. Send a test document (e.g., a one-page PDF) to the printer.
2. Go to the printer, tap your badge, and release the job.
3. Confirm that the document prints correctly with expected content and formatting.
4. Ask the user to repeat the process with a second job to ensure consistency.
5. Close the ticket and advise the user to contact the service desk if the problem recurs.

When to escalate

If the badge reader does not respond after trying a second known-good badge, or if the print spooler repeatedly crashes despite clearing the queue and reinstalling the driver, escalate to the Desktop Support lead and, if needed, to the Hardware/Facilities team for printer hardware repair. Include the printer name, IP address, spooler event logs, and badge reader model in the escalation.

Keywords: secure print release, badge tap, PaperCut, print queue stuck, printer offline, cannot add printer, blank pages, print spooler, Printer driver, Badge reader, Print.acme.example, Acme ID badge